

Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting

March 13th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting

Report

Meeting Date: March 13, 2025

Report Type: Structured Civic Analysis & Summary

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Amber opened the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission meeting on March 13, 2025, with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Commissioner Henry [00:00:09](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Brad, Michelle, and Amber (Presiding Officer). (Note: Roll call notation included board members Rob/Keisling).
 - *Absent:* None explicitly noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening Pledge of Allegiance led by Commissioner Henry 00:00:17.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the February 13, 2025 meeting were approved with a requested correction on page 2 regarding item 8e (attributing a tabling motion to Commissioner Brand rather than Keisling) 00:01:03. Approved by Voice Vote 00:02:00.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:02:12 **Item 4: 2025 Mowing RFP Bid Openings**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Bids were opened from J-Crews Landscaping and CP's Lawn Care for various parcels including Cowan Road, Innovation Drive, and Morrison Road. Discrepancies in quantities and occurrence structures were noted between the packets.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken under advisement pending legal and commission review. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote 00:08:04.
- 00:08:31 **Item 5: Baker Tilly Comprehensive TIF Report Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Eckerly, Principal with Baker Tilly (joined by Sam Trader and Juliet Dman).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Baker Tilly presented the 130-page comprehensive annual Tax Increment Finance (TIF) report and 80-slide summary presentation covering the county's allocation areas, debt obligations, revenue coverage, and legislative updates (including Senate Bill 1 and personal property assessment phase-outs).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information presentation only; no formal board action taken.
- 00:09:02 **Item 6: Daleville Shell Building Ready Grant 1.0 (East Central Indiana)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Trevor Freedberg (on behalf of Cale Hancock / ECI Regional Planning).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented details regarding a \$250,000 Ready 1 grant award for water and wastewater infrastructure on a 6.54-acre site in Salem Township. A disbursement of \$84,638.98 is ready, requiring an agreement signature. The board discussed striking section 18 on page 14 to align with current governor executive orders and noted press release restrictions in section 23.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with section 18 struck by Voice Vote 00:07:20.
- 00:07:34 **Item 7: Muncie "Make My Move" Interlocal Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Ridenour.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Mayor Ridenour presented an extension of the remote worker attraction program ("Make My Move") to cover parts of the county with Muncie mailing addresses (e.g., zip codes 47302, 47303, 47304). The Redevelopment Commission would commit \$5,000 to participate, expanding rural housing and workforce options while capturing regional economic benefits.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (with Vice President Michelle/Batters abstaining due to position) [01:14:54](#).
- [01:17:19](#) **Item 8: Mandel & Associates 5-Year Environmental Review Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Mandel and Luke Stone.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided a 5-year retrospective report on environmental oversight services, incoming industry screenings (Canpack, Clear Line, SRM Concrete, BioTech), soil/well monitoring around the South Muncie Industrial Center, and ongoing remediation updates (Exide/Garfield, Progress Rail).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information update only; no board action required.
- [01:32:46](#) **Item 9: Park One Second Entrance Update (Structure Point)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Stier (Structure Point).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update on INDOT permit approvals for the Park One second entrance. Anticipates receiving final comments/approval to let bids in April and return to the board in May.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no vote taken.
- [01:34:39](#) **Item 10: Wellpath Recovery Solutions Economic Development Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Corey McConnell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed a 40-bed regional mental health facility at the Justice Center (Asam 3.5 level facility, co-ed 20 male/20 female) aiming to create 33 initial jobs (scaling to 55.5). Uses TIF/ARPA funding to subsidize onboarding and training costs (\$294,357 for initial job training). Board members expressed questions regarding long-term operating plans and per-diem costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for further review. Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote [01:42:06](#).
- [01:42:39](#) **Item 11: Westell Request for Assistance & Commonwealth Task Order**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (Westell) / Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for financial assistance (not to exceed \$10,000) for Commonwealth to update the Preliminary Engineering Report (PER) for wastewater regionalization (tying Westell/school lines into Gaston/DCRWD rather than rebuilding the local sewage treatment plant). Accompanied by Resolution 2025-02 and a Commonwealth General Services task order.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Resolution 2025-02 Approved by Voice Vote [01:50:41](#).
 - Task Order Approved by Voice Vote [01:52:48](#).
- [01:53:07](#) **Item 12: Isaiah 117 House Fund Reallocation Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Anna.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Requested flexibility to reallocate approved grant funds across construction phases without increasing the overall \$200,000 cap previously authorized in the development agreement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:54:59](#).
- [01:55:12](#) **Item 13: Merchant McIntyre Agreement for Federal Grant Consulting**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Bill Walters.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding retaining Merchant McIntyre in Washington, D.C., to identify and secure federal grants for East Central Indiana. The board discussed regional cost-sharing with surrounding counties.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved funding up to \$80,000 by Voice Vote [02:08:12](#).
- [01:58:32](#) **Item 14: ECI RPD Agreement for Economic Development Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Brad Bookout.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the ECI Regional Planning District contract for international outreach and proactive economic development services (\$8,333.32 monthly contract). Board members discussed potential service overlaps with future executive director hiring.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion approved to pay monthly fees for January, February, and March (\$10,833.33/mo or stated monthly rate structure) by Voice Vote [02:08:12](#).
- [02:09:26](#) **Item 15: Delaware County EDA Proposal for Economic Development Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Companion proposal regarding domestic economic development and real estate broker/landowner outreach.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to discuss and table. Passed by Voice Vote [02:11:21](#).
- [02:11:28](#) **Item 16: DCRWD TIF Transfer Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Matt Eckerly.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed an accounting discrepancy identified by Bill Walters regarding year-end TIF transfers to Daleville/DCRWD that inadvertently omitted upcoming first-quarter bond and debt service obligations. Daleville has agreed to return funds to cover the shortfall.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Acknowledged and processed administratively; no formal opposing vote.
- [02:20:01](#) **Item 17: Baker Tilly Study Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Follow-up discussion on prior Baker Tilly study costs (\$3,000 / \$6,000 split).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [02:20:46](#).
- [02:21:02](#) **Item 18: Resolution for Sheriff Tony Skinner Vehicle Purchase**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formalizing resolution memorializing the prior month's approval of \$45,440 for Sheriff's Office vehicle purchases.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [02:21:54](#).
- [02:21:54](#) **Item 19: Innovation Connector Annual Operating Support Resolution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution memorializing the \$50,000 annual operating support pledge to the Innovation Connector approved in the previous meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [02:22:51](#).
- [02:23:01](#) **Item 20: County Sidewalk Project (Phases 2, 3, and 4) Land Acquisition Supplement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff (Structure Point).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Land acquisition supplement totaling \$11,420 covering three parcels (with an option to delete parcel 5 regarding a curb ramp). Total design and construction inspection cost balances were also reviewed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as presented by Voice Vote [02:25:25](#).
- [02:24:43](#) **Item 21: Target Industry Study Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy Lark (Muncie-Delaware County Economic Development Alliance).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Update on proposals for a Target Industry Study (\$110,000 high-end proposal). Secured a \$50,000 grant from the George and Francis Ball Foundation, leaving a \$60,000 funding gap to be evaluated by the ADO committee.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no funding vote taken at this time.
- [02:30:09](#) **Item 22: MOU with ECI RPD for Intern Use**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Formalizing an MOU regarding the part-time economic development intern provided through ECI RPD (working 2 days/week, ~2 hours/day, billed at an agreed hourly rate).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [02:32:06](#).
- [02:32:15](#) **Item 23: 3710 North Morrison Ratification of Grant Application**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Amber.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Ratification of an emergency grant application signature executed by Amber to meet strict submission deadlines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [02:33:21](#).
- [02:33:21](#) **Item 24: First Merchants Bank Audit Letter**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Bill Walters.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of a bank confirmation / audit letter regarding TIF accounts. Initial concerns regarding formatting and spacing ("scam" red flags) were investigated with the auditor's office and confirmed as a standard bank audit verification letter.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed by Voice Vote [02:36:47](#).

- **02:36:47 Item 25: Discussion Regarding Adoption of Bylaws**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initial review of proposed board bylaws. Discussion centered on attendance requirements, term lengths, expanded conflict of interest disclosures (employment, spouse employment, board service), and live-streaming compliance effective July.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for revisions and review at the next meeting **02:40:30**.
- **02:40:30 Item 26: Living Green Farms / Shell Building Final Payment & Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Bill Walters.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Inspection completed by Bill Walters confirming benchmarks met for final shell building draw/payment obligations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **03:11:40**.
- **02:43:08 Item 27: Resolution 25-06 / County Highway Milling Quotes & Road Repairs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Cooper / Danielle.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of road repair quotes and paving projects (comparing quotes around \$62,000 to \$64,800 for resurfacing work). Approved covering half of the low bid, contingent on MRC contributing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution and partial funding approved by Voice Vote **02:51:42**.
- **02:52:01 Item 29: Yorktown Traffic Study Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Mr. Brutin.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a traffic study agreement for Tiger Drive and River Road. It was noted that the Town of Yorktown and Town Council already funded a traffic study for this intersection.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to deny the request. Approved by Voice Vote **02:54:28**.
- **02:54:28 Item 30: Industrial Center Trail Rail Crossing Engineering Estimates (Enginuity)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Joey Martin (Enginuity).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented engineering and railroad force account cost estimates for completing the South Muncie Industrial Center Trail railroad crossing (including dual-arm gates and Z-crossing pedestrian safety fencing), totaling approximately \$46,000 for road/trail construction plus railroad force account fees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **02:58:20**.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public offered general floor comments during the open public comment period.*

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Administrative Notes:** The board took a 15-minute recess at 11:05 AM 01:51:18 to relocate to a common area due to a room scheduling conflict. Authorized Amber and Danielle to update bank account signers, removing Brad Bookout and adding Amber Green 03:09:00.
 - **Adjournment:** Official meeting concluded following the final voice votes.
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